

OSF × ANDELA HACKATHON 2026 · BUILD FOR AFRICA, TAKE IT TO KENYA

VeriVoice

Verify. Understand. Act.

A multilingual civic information assistant that helps Kenyans check the voice notes, messages, and screenshots they receive — before they act on them or share them.

Angela Odhiambo · Nairobi, Kenya · October 2026

angelcoder87.github.io/Verivoice · github.com/Angelcoder87/Verivoice

THE PROBLEM

The information arrives a

A rumour about school fees. A fake tender. A distorted quote from a county budget. By the time it reaches a market trader in Gikomba, it is spoken text in Sheng, not an article with a URL.

Verification should not be a privilege of the already well-informed.

Voice-first

WhatsApp voice notes are the dominant form in Kenyan group chats. There is no link to check and no text to paste.

Costly

Misinformation has driven mob action, depressed vaccine uptake, and buried real corruption behind noise.

WHO IT IS BUILT FOR

Built for the people most exposed

to harmful information — and least equipped to challenge it:

Market traders

Acting on forwarded price notices that move their stock.

Parents

Reacting to school-fee rumours days before term starts.

Matatu crews

Sharing route and security alerts with whole routes.

Community groups

Coordinating around county budgets and tenders.

THE USER MOMENT

Someone sends you a voice note. You have 30 seconds and 20 MB of data.
Do you believe it, ignore it, or forward it?

VeriVoice gives that decision a fourth option: check it.

THE SOLUTION

An assistant that checks what you receive

Submit information exactly as it reached you. VeriVoice verifies it, explains the result in your language, and gives you something safe to share back.

Voice note

Speak or upload. No typing needed. Sheng and Kiswahili are understood, not rejected.

Text

Paste the message exactly as it was forwarded.

Screenshot

Photograph the screen you saw it on; the text is read and checked.

One pipeline, five stages

1 Transcription & OCR

Audio becomes text; text inside screenshots is read. Sheng and Kiswahili are understood, not rejected.

2 Claim extraction

The message is broken into the specific claims a person might act on.

3 Evidence retrieval

Each claim is checked against official circulars, news, and published fact-checks.

4 AI reconciliation

Evidence is weighed against the claim. Confidence and gaps are recorded, never hidden.

An assistant, never an oracle.

VeriVoice never claims the authority to declare truth. Every verdict shows its evidence, its confidence, and its limits.

- **Verdicts, not decrees — Supported, Disputed, Misleading, or Unverified**
- **Sources you can open — Every claim links to its evidence**
- **Honest confidence — Stated with the number and the reason**
- **What we do not know — Stated in plain words on every card**
- **Next steps — Real institutions, real hotlines, real options**

WHEN EVIDENCE IS THIN, IT SAYS SO:

"Hakuna ushahidi wa kutosha. Usiendelee kusambaza hadi uthibitishwe."

"There is not enough evidence. Do not spread it until it is confirmed."

One card per claim, everything a decision

- 1 The claim, restated simply
- 2 The verdict, in a badge you can read at arm's length
- 3 The evidence, with named sources you can open
- 4 Confidence — and what we do not know
- 5 Next steps, including exactly who to confirm with

BUILT FOR REAL CONDITIONS

Low bandwidth

Text-first, lightweight responses. Share cards are a few lines, not a video. Runs in the browser — no install, no app store.

Accessibility

Voice-first input means no typing. Large text and plain language serve low-literacy users.

Multilingual

English, Kiswahili, and a full Sheng interface (EN / SW / SH). People do not switch registers to verify a rumour.

Privacy

No account needed. The PoC processes everything in your browser — nothing is retained, nothing leaves your phone without your act.

WHY IT MATTERS

Shifting the power to judge to communities

OSF's Transformative Peace in Africa initiative is about moving power into the hands of communities. VeriVoice does that for information: verification becomes a capability people perform themselves, not a service performed about them.

Cross-track fit. Reducing friction between communities (Stability & Social Cohesion) and helping people scrutinize official decisions (Transparency & Accountability) — with honest answers, not verdicts by decree.

Today: one user checks one claim

A parent catches a fake fee notice before paying. A trader refuses a fraudulent paybill. The correction reaches one group chat.

Tomorrow: a community checks itself

Radio call-in segments and a public claim-check page mean one check serves a whole market, a whole route, a whole ward.

ROADMAP

From invention sprint to everyday habit

- Now (PoC):** Full core loop, live today — voice, text, and screenshot in; verdicts, sources, honest unknowns, and next steps out, with a curated five-scenario evidence base including the 2027 election calendar.
- Next:** WhatsApp integration. Verify by forwarding to a VeriVoice number — no new app to install.
- Then:** Community radio call-in verification segments and a public claim-check page.
- Later:** Offline-tolerant caching of frequently checked claims; expansion to more countries and languages.

SEE IT WORK

Live demo: angelcoder87.github.io/Verivoice

Source code: github.com/Angelcoder87/Verivoice

Try it with your own voice note, message, or screenshot.